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investment asset. Its capped supply of 21 million coins appeals to investors seeking an inflation hedge, akin to gold. Institutional adoption by companies like Tesla and MicroStrategy, along with increasing interest in Bitcoin ETFs from firms like BlackRock, has further solidified its status as a legitimate asset class. Millennials and younger investors are particularly drawn to Bitcoin for its digital nature and higher potential returns compared to traditional assets like gold.

India's Digital Rupee aims to strengthen interbank settlements and retail payment systems while reducing cash dependence. Unlike Bitcoin, it operates within a centralised framework, ensuring alignment with the RBI's policies. This approach highlights the contrasting paths between Bitcoin's libertarian vision and central banks' pursuit of digital financial innovation.

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Bitcoin as Legal Tender

Bitcoin's evolution highlights its resilience. While its decentralised design and price instability limit its viability as a mainstream currency, it continues to thrive as an asset class, competing with gold in the digital economy. Meanwhile, nations worldwide are prioritising CBDCs over cryptocurrencies like Bitcoin, leveraging blockchain technology to modernise payments while maintaining control over monetary systems. For Bitcoin, its future lies not as a currency but as a cornerstone of the modern financial ecosystem, redefining wealth preservation and investment in the digital age. **BT**

Views are personal